# Malte H. Hinrichs

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## Education

**PhD in Economics** 10/2023–present
Queen's University Belfast, UK
Affiliated with: Centre for Economics, Policy and History (CEPH)
Dissertation Title: *Water, Wheels, and the Wealth of Nations: Geography and Path Dependence in European Industrialization*
Submission: 27/08/2026 · Viva: 21/10/2026

**MSc Economics** 09/2020–09/2022
University of Mannheim, Germany
Thesis: *Engines of Growth? The Role of the Steam Engine for Long-Run Economic Development in Germany*

**Visiting Student** 02/2021–06/2021
NHH Norwegian School of Economics, Norway

**BSc Economics** 09/2017–08/2020
University of Mannheim, Germany
Thesis: *The Long-Term Effects of Colonialism on Income Inequality*

**Visiting Student** 08/2019–12/2019
Hong Kong University of Science and Technology, Hong Kong

## Publications

"Water mills and human capital accumulation in industrialising Prussia" 07/2026
*Explorations in Economic History*, 101(1): 101767.
Article: doi:10.1016/j.eeh.2026.101767
Replication Package: doi:10.17632/pvnh7g4b39.2

## Job Market Paper

"Leapfrogging or path dependence? Water mills and long-run growth in the Scottish Industrial Revolution"
Latest draft available on my website.

**Abstract:** Does technological change favour agile entrants or adaptable incumbents? I examine this using Scotland's industrialisation, testing whether steam power allowed new locations to "leapfrog" centres of water power. Using a newly constructed dataset linking over 1,200 pre-industrial mills to parish-level outcomes, and an instrumental variable strategy based on geographic endowments, I reject the leapfrogging hypothesis. An additional mill in 1755 caused 8% higher long-run population growth (driven by migration), with effects intensifying precisely when steam power became abundant. Micro-evidence reveals that hydraulically advantaged mill sites largely survived, transitioned to industrial production and avoided obsolescence by integrating steam power as a complementary technology. The findings demonstrate that proto-industrial water power provided the critical infrastructure and human capital for the steam age, challenging the view that coal endowments alone determined the industrial map.

## Working Papers

"Market access without roads: First-nature geography and European city growth, 700–1800"
Draft available upon request.

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## Teaching Experience

**Queen's University Belfast**

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| Principles of Economics, Teaching Assistant (course design, tutorials) | 09/2025–01/2026 |
| Principles of Economics, Teaching Assistant (tutorials, exam supervision, marking) | 09/2024–01/2025 |

**University of Mannheim**

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|---|---|
| Macroeconomics A, Teaching Assistant (tutorials, student mentoring) | 02/2020–08/2020 |
| Statistics II, Teaching Assistant (tutorials, student mentoring) | 09/2019–12/2019 |
| Principles of Economics, Teaching Assistant (tutorials, exam organisation) | 09/2018–12/2018 |

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## Honours and Awards

**Winner, Three Minute Thesis (3MT®) Competition**, Queen's University Belfast 04/2026

**New Researcher Prize**, Economic History Society 04/2026

**Graduated in top 20% of MSc Economics cohort**, University of Mannheim 09/2022

**Graduated in top 10% of BSc Economics cohort**, University of Mannheim 08/2020

**Dean's List**, Hong Kong University of Science and Technology 12/2019

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## Research Grants and Funding

**Santander Career Support Award** 05/2026

**Economic History Society New Researcher Conference Bursary** 01/2026

**EHES Conference Travel and Accommodation Grant** 07/2025

**Economic History Society Young Scholar Conference Bursary** 01/2025

**CEPH Studentship**, Irish Higher Education Authority, full funding for PhD studies 10/2023

**PROMOS Scholarship**, German Academic Exchange Service, full funding for HKUST 06/2019

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## Professional Memberships

Economic History Society (UK)

European Historical Economics Society

Irish Economic Association

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## Academic Presentations

Invited Talks

**Graduate Seminar in Economic and Social History**, University of Oxford 05/2026

**Economic History Seminar**, University of Hohenheim 03/2026

**Department of Economics Seminar Series**, Heriot-Watt University Edinburgh 01/2026

**Centre for Economic History Seminar Series**, Queen's University Belfast 04/2024

Conference and Workshop Presentations

**CEPH PhD Workshop**, Queen's University Belfast 05/2026

**Queen's Postgraduate Research Conference**, Queen's University Belfast 05/2026

**Economic History Society Conference**, London School of Economics 04/2026

**Irish Postgraduate and Early Career Economics Workshop**, Maynooth University 01/2026

**European Historical Economics Society Conference**, University of Hohenheim 09/2025

**CEPH Workshop in Quantitative Economic History**, Queen's University Belfast 06/2025

**Queen's Postgraduate Research Conference**, Queen's University Belfast 06/2025

**Economic History Society Conference**, University of Strathclyde 04/2025

**Centre for Economic History PhD Discussion Group**, Queen's University Belfast 02/2025

**Centre for Economic History PhD Discussion Group**, Queen's University Belfast 03/2024

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## Professional Development

**Graduate Teaching Assistant Workshop**, The Economics Network 01/2025

**Economic History Society Residential Training**, University of Warwick 11/2024

**Financial, Economic and Business History Summer School**, University of Groningen 06/2024

**Workshop for Teaching Assistants**, University of Mannheim 09/2018

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## Public Engagement

*'Die Kraft des Wassers: Deutschlands vergessene Industrialisierung'* 08/2026
Featured Interview, GEO Magazine (Germany)

*'Chatting GPT: What does history tell us about the future of AI?'* 10/2025
Invited Speaker, ESRC Festival of Social Science

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## Industry Experience

**KPMG AG Wirtschaftsprüfungsgesellschaft**
Junior Consultant, Global Transfer Pricing (Mannheim, Germany) 04/2023–09/2023

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## Technical Skills

**Econometric & Spatial Methods:** Causal Inference (IV/2SLS, DiD, Panel/FE), Spatial Econometrics, GIS & Cost-Surface Analysis, Gravity Modelling

**Software & Programming:** R (`sf`, `terra`), Python, Stata, Matlab, QGIS, Git, Quarto, LaTeX

**Languages:** German (native), English (fluent), Spanish (intermediate), Latin (reading)

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## References

**Chris Colvin** (PhD Supervisor)
Queen's University Belfast
chris.colvin@qub.ac.uk · Website

**Alexander Donges** (MSc & BSc Advisor)
University of Mannheim
donges@uni-mannheim.de · Website

**Alan Fernihough** (PhD Supervisor)
Queen's University Belfast
a.fernihough@qub.ac.uk · Website

**John Turner** (CEPH Director)
Queen's University Belfast
j.turner@qub.ac.uk · Website

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